Students’ Perceptions of Learning Task Delegation

You are invited to take part in a study on how higher education students decide which learning tasks, such as taking notes, reading, or preparing for exams, they are willing to delegate to generative AI (e.g., ChatGPT, Claude), and how this compares to other forms of support. We are also interested in whether this differs between students with and without disabilities / neurodivergence / chronic illness.

This project is carried out by Dr. Oriane Pierrès (Project Lead, Digital Society Initiative (DSI), University of Zurich), Diana Pak, and Prof. Dr. Joshua Weidlich (Institut für Erziehungswissenschaft and DSI, University of Zurich).

To take part, you must be at least 18 years old, enrolled at a Swiss higher education institution, and have completed at least one semester.

What participation involves

The survey takes about 20 to 30 minutes and is structured as follows:

1. A few questions to check that you are eligible to take part.
2. A question about whether you live with a disability, neurodivergence or chronic illness affecting your studies (yes/no/I am not sure). If you do, you will select from a list which condition(s) you live with.
3. A short scenario about exam preparation, followed by questions about six learning strategies (e.g., note-taking, reading, self-testing). For each strategy, you indicate your preferred level of AI support, how much you agree with a set of statements, and how AI compares to other options, and you explain your ranking in a short open-ended answer. If you indicated a disability, neurodivergence or chronic illness, you will also answer one short open-ended question per strategy (six in total) on how it relates to your AI use.
4. A few questions about yourself (e.g., gender, field of study), about the difficulties and strengths you experience in your academic life, and about how you approach your studies.

Why take part

Your answers help researchers and universities better understand how students want to use AI in their studies, including students with disabilities / neurodivergence / chronic illness, whose perspective is often missing from AI policy discussions. There is no direct personal benefit beyond the optional prize draw.

Possible inconveniences

Minimal risk. Some participants may find it uncomfortable to disclose living with a disability / neurodivergence / chronic illness and/or reflect on it. This is health information; you may stop and withdraw from the study at any time.

In addition, the survey asks about gender and racial/ethnic background; these are optional (“prefer not to say” available) and used to describe the sample and explore group differences.

Voluntary participation

Participation is voluntary. You may stop at any point without giving a reason and without consequence. You can leave the survey and come back later in the same browser, without creating an account. To resume a survey in this manner, you should not have deleted your browser cookies in the meantime and use the same link. If you do not complete the survey, your incomplete answers will not be included in the analysis. Because completed responses are anonymous, we cannot remove individual answers once submitted.

Data protection

Your responses are anonymous (no name, e-mail, or IP address collected with your answers). Data are stored on UZH-managed OneDrive, accessible only to the research team, and retained at least 10 years as required for scientific publications.

If you join the prize draw, your e-mail is collected on a separate, unlinked page and deleted after the draw.

Anonymized closed-ended data (ratings, rankings, demographics) may be published on an open repository (e.g., OSF). All open-ended responses will not be published.

Compensation

At the end of the survey, you can optionally enter a draw for one of ten 100 CHF Migros vouchers.

Questions or concerns

For any questions related to this study, you may contact Dr. Oriane Pierrès, oriane.pierres@dsi.uzh.ch, Digital Society Initiative, University of Zurich.

For ethical concerns related to this study, please contact the Ethics Committee, Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences: chair.ethics.committee@phil.uzh.ch.

There are 52 questions in this survey.

This survey is anonymous.

The record of your survey responses does not contain any identifying information about you, unless a specific survey question explicitly asked for it.

If you used an identifying access code to access this survey, please rest assured that this code will not be stored together with your responses. It is managed in a separate database and will only be updated to indicate whether you did (or did not) complete this survey. There is no way of matching identification access codes with survey responses.

Consent

By clicking “I agree to participate,” you confirm that:

- You have read and understood the above, and had the chance to ask questions.
- You understand participation is voluntary.
- You understand your data are anonymous and closed-ended data may be published openly.

☐ **I agree to participate in this study.**

Note: Participation can only be confirmed online on the survey platform.